PROactive PRONUNCIATION

Linking: Similar Consonants

In English, there are “sister sounds,” or nearly identical sounds; only one sound has the voice on, and the other does not. Below are examples of sister sound pairs:

If a word ends and another starts with these pairs, you would pronounce the sound once. Generally, the voiceless sound prevails. In some cases you transition from voiced to voiceless, but essentially you make the sound once, not placing a pause between the sounds.

Examples:

p/b:	Step brother	> ste**p**rother
s/z:	six zippers	> si**x**ippers
t/d:	had to	> ha**t**o
k/g:	big canoe	> bi**c**anoe
sh/ch:	catch shrimp	> cat**ch**ripm
f/v:	have four	> ha**f**our
θ/ð:	with them	> wi**th**em